

LET ME TRY · FREE PRINTABLE

Dal Sorting: 5 Levels of Focus

Sensorial and fine-motor work · Ages 3–4

A ₹0 activity from your kitchen. Each level makes the work a little harder. Stay at a level until your child finishes it calmly, then move on.

Safety first

Always supervise. Skip this activity if your child still puts small objects in their mouth, and start with large beans like rajma and chana.

The 5 levels

- ○ Level 1: Two large beans (rajma + chana), sorted by hand into two katoris.
- ○ Level 2: Same beans, moved with a small spoon.
- ○ Level 3: Small wooden tongs or a clothes peg.
- ○ Level 4: Three or four dals, sorted into a muffin tray.
- ○ Level 5: Small grains (moong, masoor) with tweezers, for older 4-year-olds.

How to present it

- ○ Put everything on a tray, so the work has a clear 'home'.
- ○ Show slowly once: pick, look, drop. No talking.
- ○ Let them repeat as many times as they like.
- ○ At the end, show how to pour everything back for next time.

Talk while they work (later, not during)

- ○ Name the dals: rajma, chana, moong, masoor.
- ○ Compare: big and small, smooth and wrinkly, dark and light.
- ○ Count a few: 'Let's count 5 rajma.'

Extend it

- ○ Help wash and soak the dal for dinner.
- ○ Make a dal collage on cardboard with glue.
- ○ Fill and seal small bottles as shakers to compare sounds.

SOURCES AND FURTHER READING

Montessori, M. The Montessori Method (sensorial education).
Lillard, A. S. (2017). Montessori: The Science Behind the Genius. Oxford University Press.

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